COLOR ME BACK! — CHAPTER 1: THE RUBY ORCHARD

Detailed narrative, gameplay, cinematic and implementation script | Beta production draft v1.0

Document status: DRAFT FOR CREATOR REVIEW. Source: *Color Me Back | Expanded Game Development Bible*, dated 16 October 2026, with comparison to the earlier three-page Chapter 1 brief and existing starter-code README. New technical targets and connective dialogue below are original PROPOSALS, not approved canon, shipped features or completed assets.

Playable goal: A polished, coherent single-player, third-person 3D beta that tells a beginning-to-end Ruby rescue story, from the child's colorless bedroom to the first spectacular restoration. **Beta duration:** about 20–30 minutes depending on exploration and retries. **Future complete Chapter 1:** 55–80 minutes main path plus 20–35 minutes optional, as proposed on page 8 of the expanded Bible. These are planning targets, not measured timings.

Premise: Ruby is a gentle dragon caught in a spell that magnifies fear of making mistakes. Her uncontrolled berry magic makes her orchard unsafe. The child helps her be brave enough to try again. **Emotional theme:** Courage without perfection. **No one is attacked to cause injury**: the goal is to break the three imprisoning crystals. The child can make mistakes and still succeed.

A. Canon and proposal register — read before coding

Topic	Earlier handoff	Expanded Bible (16 Oct 2026)	Chapter 1 beta assumption
Red Guardian	Ruby the Rumble Dragon	Keep Ruby, with clumsy fear-amplifying seal	KEEP
Color progression	Red -> Blue -> Yellow; later mixes	Seven Lords proposed, but RED/BLUE/YELLOW remain only primary paint supplies	Red only in this beta; later chapter flags reserved
Dash	Crimson Dash unlocked after Ruby	Basic dash in prologue; Flame Burst after Ruby	**PROVISIONALLY** follow expanded version, creator sign-off pending
Boss design	Three gentle phases	Three phases, threats continue during puzzle solving, generous checkpoints	Follow expanded version
Main-story scope	Short ~18–25-minute demo	Ruby full chapter 55–80 minutes plus optional content	Build ~20–30-minute core beta, then extend without replacing systems
Art	Earlier reference images	Older posters are mood boards, not approved playable 3D assets; chubby/cute/toy-like is proposed target	Build original childlike art pass and approval tests
Season Two	Possible co-op	Season One SOLO; co-op later only	Solo only

Approval gate: Confirm Flame Burst versus Crimson Dash and the larger seven-Lord storyline BEFORE treating this as locked production canon. The beta can use Flame Burst provisionally without rewriting old documents or save data irreversibly.

B. The ten golden rules — mandatory, not optional

1. **No pay-to-win.** Full story, all Lord powers, all standard pets and every functional traversal ability must be earnable free.
2. **Seven shades included.** Buying one legendary pet cosmetic includes seven freely selectable color palettes; never sell its palette colors separately.
3. **A real free path to one premium cosmetic.** The proposed 600-Gem legendary skin must be obtainable by a reasonably achievable, permanent F2P path. The full Bible models an early 660-Gem pathway; DO NOT implement real purchases in this beta.
4. **Childlike 3D heroes.** Young-looking, chubby/cute, rounded and soft-edged; neither adult realism nor glossy anime portraits.
5. **Legendary means cosmetic spectacle.** Redesigned silhouette, outfit, motions and VFX can be much richer but must match the world's material language and NEVER improve gameplay statistics.
6. **Bosses keep moving.** In default Adventure mode, readable attacks continue while the child rotates mirrors, paints symbols or solves puzzles; choose Story assist for gentle pacing or hazard pause.
7. **Teach then reuse.** Every new mechanic has an obvious tutorial, an easy test, a combination test and later mastery use. Double jump and grappling recur in future chapters, not earned here.
8. **Rescue, do not injure.** Color Lords are spell victims, not villains. The Fade is helped, not killed.
9. **Solo first.** Season One is a solo adventure; optional co-op, hard rematches and miniature Lord pets belong only to possible Season Two.
10. **Creator approves.** Concept art, numbers, prices, calendars and added worldbuilding are proposals until explicitly approved.

Additional constraints: Inclusive natural skin tones stay natural when scenery is grayscale; text + distinct symbols accompany color; save checkpoints; subtitles; no public child chat, photos, ad tracking, or shop in beta.

C. The opening promise — what the player should feel

- In the bedroom: curiosity and a small mystery, never horror.
- With Pip: warmth, humor, safety and companionship.
- On first sight of Ruby: a large magical spectacle, but Ruby is visibly frightened rather than threatening.
- During the orchard: constantly changing scale and tactile, readable 3D interactions; giant berries, slippery jam, wobbly bridges, mirrored rays.
- During the boss: exhilaration from movement and puzzle timing. *The player is rescuing someone while the environment misbehaves.*
- At the restoration: a unique, emotionally satisfying payoff with permanently changed 3D scenery, music and clothing details.

D. Scene ledger, pacing and checkpoints

Scene ID	Location	Beta goal	Approx. mins	Save event
P00	Start and child-select	Pick either Explorer, same gameplay stats	1–2	selection
P01	Bedroom	Notice missing colors, find Pip	2–3	bedroom done
P02	Hush Hollow courtyard	Wonderbrush tap, movement, jump, basic dash	3–4	berry arch reached
R01	Orchard Arrival / overlook	Meet Ruby; establish three spell crystals	1–2	orchard entry
R02	Berry Trail / stepping stones	Move and dodge; learn rolling-fruit tells	3–4	trail cleared
R03	Reversible mirror garden	Activate one mirror without hazard	2–3	mirror done
R04	Jam-Jar Stage	Resolve the Jam-Jar Jester's three-pot puzzle	3–4	mini-boss clear
R05	Ruby arena, Phase A	Berry Parade + first crystal	2–3	ruby_phase_1
R06	Ruby arena, Phase B	Three Mirrors, Many Berries	3–4	ruby_phase_2
R07	Ruby arena, Phase C	Three stomp waves + final crystal	2–3	ruby_phase_3
R08	Restoration cinematic	Red returns dynamically across orchard	~1	ruby_restored
R09	Flame Courtyard	Receive dye and learn Flame Burst	2–3	power_test_complete
R10	Return to Hush Hollow	Ruby closure and tease Whisperwave Bay	1	chapter_1_complete

Pacing note: scene lengths overlap with retries/cutscenes, so the beta target is approximately 20–30 minutes overall, not a strict sum of every row. Shorten idle transitions, not important gameplay. All scenes have a no-softlock exit and a fast-forward option for previously seen cinematics.

E. FULL PLAYABLE STORY SCRIPT

P00 — THE FIRST BRUSHSTROKE | Title and character choice

Visual: Dim yet beautiful painted-paper storybook title, almost monochrome; three empty primary-color sockets arranged around a rounded Wonderbrush silhouette. Soft motes float slowly. Subtle, not flashing.

UI: START ADVENTURE, CONTINUE (if save exists), SETTINGS, HOW TO PLAY. Character select: Boy Explorer / Girl Explorer, identical stats, same scale and basic rig, inclusive starter choices. No real-name field required; a fixed in-game nickname can be used offline. Three freely available opening outfits in full game; beta may show one polished outfit per preset if it clearly does not falsely claim full customization.

Player input: choice + confirmation; accessible focus cues; previous save warning only when genuinely overwriting data.

Audio: One music-box note; distant wind-chime. No startling bass drop.

QA: Both choices reach identical starting coordinates; equal movement speed/jump/collision/skills; no gender-dependent dialogue or rewards.

P01 — THE MORNING THE COLORS DISAPPEARED | Bedroom cutscene + micro-exploration

Weather/time: Soft clouded midmorning. Outside the bedroom window, low pearly fog drifting between toy-shaped roofs; a weak patch of sunlight creates gentle shadows but does not imply yellow was restored.

Camera C01: Close on the child's hand holding a painted drawing of a big berry, curling wave and small sun. Pigment quietly streams out of the page. **C02:** Camera pulls across a teddy, crayon box, curtain and drawing as each loses its color. **C03:** Wide of the bedroom window; rooflines are desaturated. **C04:** Mirror close-up: the outfit's decorative trim is gray; child's natural skin tone remains natural. Camera never stares at blank gray for long: warm form/lighting make it beautiful.

Narrator (optional voice/subtitles): “One morning, Hush Hollow forgot how to shine. Not how to laugh. Not how to dream. Just how to be colorful.”

EXPLORER: “Wait... where did my red crayon go?”

Interaction 1, TEDDY: A soft squeeze; gentle squeak; prompt “Inspect — E”. **EXPLORER:** “You look a little sleepy, too.”

Interaction 2, CRAYON BOX: One empty outline of each primary color; hints show label + fruit/wave/sun symbol. **EXPLORER:** “The pictures are still here, but their colors aren't!”

Interaction 3, WINDOW: Slow look out to Hush Hollow; a tiny levitating brush taps the glass.

PIP (tiny voice from outside): “Psst! If you're looking for colors, I'm very good at looking!”

EXPLORER: “Who said that?”

PIP (drops into the room, lands bristle-first, spins upright): “Pip! Paintbrush, guide, professional finder of almost everything.”

EXPLORER: “Then can you find my color?”

PIP: “I think we can find everybody's. But first... would you help me wake this old Wonderbrush?”

Cutscene blend: Pip rises, musical sparkle, control returns; arrows point to the paintbrush in its cradle. Do not create an unskippable 90-second cinema before the player has agency.

Checkpoint: `prologue_bedroom_complete` after pickup. **Assist:** an icon pulses after 20 seconds, Pip gives a hint after 35 seconds. **Camera:** smooth shoulder-height third-person on control handoff.

P02 — HUSH HOLLOW: THE TWO SLEEPING STARS | Core controls, brush and dash

Environment: Small village square: rounded doors, hand-painted plaster, felt awnings, broad paving stones, birdhouses, oversized craft props, muted grayscale with natural accents. Branches and fabrics move in a slow breeze. An orchard arch is visible across square.

Tutorial A: Move WASD/arrow keys; camera mouse drag; jump SPACE across a safe 0.7-meter visual gap; practice basic dash (Shift) across a broad courtyard stripe. A short glow trail follows dash, but red stays locked. No fall penalties beyond instant ledge reset.

PIP: “Take a little step. Now a hop! Your feet already remember how to be brave.”

Tutorial B: Look at first sleepy star, E / contextual Wonderbrush tap. Glow travels along engraved lines and awakens the star with a white-gold accessibility glint (not restoring yellow pigment).

EXPLORER: “That wasn't so hard!”

PIP: “Excellent! A real artist always tries more than one brushstroke.”

Tutorial C: Second star requires moving, jumping and a brush tap. Large star-shaped reticle; no precise dragging.

PIP: “See those berry stamps on the road? They lead to someone who needs our help.”

Optional village villager: “My little flower is shy. Maybe it'll find its color later.” This creates an optional post-restoration callback, not an unfinished mandatory quest.

Exit: Arch opens, curved petals fall silently in grayscale. **Transition camera:** tracks from Explorer's feet to a distant giant berry tree and zooms toward the Orchard. **Checkpoint:** `ruby_entry`.

R01 — THE ORCHARD THAT FORGOT RED | Arrival cinematic

Weather/time: Late morning; soft overcast with a tiny ray cutting through light mist. Breezes sway enormous berry stems. Occasional pollen/dust motes float; colors remain carefully muted. Giant branches frame the horizon, with a distant jam mill and crystal grove. The orchard should look expensive and atmospheric despite having no restored colors.

Camera: crane over cracked jam-wheel and berry stepping-stones; Ruby is glimpsed in the distance, curled protectively beneath THREE dull luminous crystals. Her silhouette is broad, round, gentle, unmistakably a young-friendly dragon. Wings tremble rather than menace.

PIP: “Those fruit are behaving like bowling balls!”

RUBY (calling, anxious): “I promise I am usually a very polite dragon!”

EXPLORER: “Ruby? Are you okay?”

RUBY: “I wanted every berry to be perfect. Then I got worried... and they all started bouncing.”

PIP: “Those three crystals look like a very unhelpful spell. Let's figure them out.”

Objective HUD: “Reach Ruby's crystal grove” with berry icon and broad world-space trail. **Unlock:** no new color yet.

R02 — BERRY TRAIL: SOMETHING IS ROLLING | Exploration + hazard tutorial

Level shape: A readable S-curve through giant fruit stalks. One safe stepped platform, one rolling-berry lane, one short duck-alcove, two large jumping pads; camera retains view of landing targets. Props include knitted twine rope fences and tiny jam taps. Two enemy archetypes are **Bouncing Berry** (rolling environmental hazard) and **Ink Twig** (shy patrol which gently pushes the player backwards on contact).

Gameplay rhythm: (1) see a large berry roll on a distant loop; (2) wait for a symbol-marked landing circle, step aside; (3) cross stepping stones; (4) use basic dash to cross a wider—but safe—lane; (5) use Wonderbrush tap to open a gate.

PIP: “Follow the round berry stamps!”

EXPLORER: “We can get close without scaring her.”

Optional Ink Twig dialogue: It squeaks “Oh!” and recoils when a Wonderbrush tap removes its sticky gray spell tag; no enemy death animation. Ink Twig returns to watering a plant.

Hazard tell: projected circle icon appears 2 seconds before berry arrives, plus bell chime and closed captions “[berry rolling nearby]”. Its outline may use accessibility UI accents before the red pigment is recovered, but never saturate an actual orchard fruit prematurely.

Mistake behavior: The player is bounced to last safe pad, with a gentle bounce and no HP death screen. Three mistakes: Pip offers a slowed berry option. **Checkpoint:** `ruby_trail_clear`.

R03 — THE LITTLE MIRROR GARDEN | Calm puzzle rehearsal

Purpose: Teach the exact mirror interaction BEFORE the Ruby fight under pressure.

Visual: Three antique-looking, oversized, rounded mirrors with ceramic petals; only first required now. A neutral white reflected guide ray points away from a sealed gate. The puzzle is NOT color-dependent; arrow shapes show direction.

EXPLORER: “The light goes the wrong way.”

PIP: “One little twist can change where it lands.”

Player action: Approach mirror and press E to rotate it exactly 90 degrees per input. Each direction change produces a visible white ghost line, subtle chime, and a tactile 'click' animation. Align mirror -> beam reaches leaf-shaped receptor -> gate opens. No danger in this rehearsal.

PIP: “Nice! We'll remember that when things get wobblier.”

Save: `ruby_mirror_tutorial`.

R04 — JAM-JAR JESTER | Nonviolent mini-boss, active playground puzzle

Encounter space: A semicircular jam mill courtyard with three giant bowls (left circle icon, middle triangle, right star), waist-high safety islands and a bell tower. A whimsical, bouncy jam jar character in an oversized paper crown blocks the exit.

JESTER: “No paint beyond this point!”

PIP: “Oh! A jar with a very large opinion!”

JESTER: “I have a job: KEEP. EVERYTHING. TIDY.”

EXPLORER: “Maybe tidy doesn't have to mean stuck.”

Mechanic: Jester lobs bouncy jam blobs with clear landing indicators, one every 7–9 seconds in Adventure. Three marked pots require a bounced projectile to land inside. During 2–3-second windows, a Wonderbrush-tapped plate redirects one blob into the chosen bowl. Each correct bowl locks and shows an icon + audible marimba note; incorrect shots harmlessly bounce away, no lost progress.

Three outcomes: first bowl teaches; second introduces alternating blob lanes; third introduces a platform jump but keeps all three bowls readable. No attack animation resembling painful injury; upon success the Jester bursts into harmless gray berry mist, reappears smiling with a little rubber duck, and steps aside.

JESTER: “Well! That was rather less tidy... and much more fun.”

RUBY (far away): “I do not want to keep making messes.”

Save: `jam_jar_jester_clear`. **QA:** Jester clear persists after reload; bowl puzzle cannot get permanently stuck by projectile physics.

R05 — RUBY BOSS, PHASE 1: THE BOUNCING BERRY PARADE

Arena overview: Circular 26–34-meter *provisional* gameplay space, three safe islands, one wide entry portal, three differently shaped crystal pedestals and clear sky camera lanes. Ruby is in the background, never a hittable target. Use broad collision and generous traversal space. The camera must show the first crystal and berry threat together.

PIP: “Ruby! We're here to help, not to hurt you!”

RUBY: “Oh, berries! Please stop bouncing over my friends!”

EXPLORER: “I can paint the crystal after the bounce!”

Objective: Safely avoid 2–3 telegraphed berry landings, then approach the triangle-marked spell crystal and use a short brush tap. Berry hazards run independently while crystal interaction is active. Each berry warning: visible patterned landing circle -> sound -> descending fruit -> soft bounce -> 2–3-second safe action gap. `Phase1` passes only after validated brush hit + crystal opening cinematic, not raw proximity.

Progress feedback: Crystal opens like a paper flower, one crystal icon fills in the HUD, Ruby's tail relaxes.

Checkpoint: `ruby_phase_1`. Optional hint after 3 failed dodges; never reset the crystal once saved.

R06 — RUBY BOSS, PHASE 2: THREE MIRRORS, MANY BERRIES

The showcase mechanic and highest priority beta test. Circular subarena with a waist-high center safe island, three rotatable mirrors, ONE crystal receptor, three landing circles and a visible exit gate. Puzzle and hazard state machines run at the same time; opening an interact tooltip does NOT suspend hazard simulation in default Adventure mode.

Phase entry: 2-second overhead preview shows three mirror locations, then immediately returns to playable chase view; player is NEVER stuck in prolonged cinematic while attacks continue.

PIP: “Turn the mirrors, but keep an eye on those berry circles!”

RUBY: “You can do two things at once. I believe in you!”

Example expected sequence, not forced timing:

- T+0: phase checkpoint loaded; mirror receivers show pale ghost beam route; berry timer begins independently.
- T+2: first landing marker appears; Pip: “Circle on the floor — step away!”
- T+4: berry harmlessly rebounds; short interaction opening; mirror 1 rotates 90 degrees with E.
- T+7: next telegraphed berry approaches while 2 mirrors remain incomplete; player dodges without resetting mirror 1.
- T+10: mirror 2 rotates; white preview ray now points toward mirror 3.
- T+13: mirror 3 rotates; ray reaches heart-shaped receptor; crystal opens; only then is the hazard sequencer stopped.

Important implementation detail: The exact times above are STORYBOARD samples. In code, the player controls the pace. Puzzle state persists between dodges, attack telegraphs are world-space objects, and logic never assumes the player moves at storyboard speed. Three mistakes ->

offer optional slow-berries toggle; after ~90 seconds -> optional beam-preview hint; Story mode can skip after demonstrated attempts if the creator approves. Never spawn a berry onto the only mirror interaction location without safe escape.

EXPLORER: “That last mirror... there!”

RUBY: “Oh! One of my wings feels lighter.”

Checkpoint: `ruby_phase_2`; persist mirror solution and crystal state.

R07 — RUBY BOSS, PHASE 3: THE THREE STOMPS

Escalation: Ruby's worried spell causes THREE large, slow, radiating shockwave rings, not angry attacks. Shapes on floor indicate timing; three low berry ledges provide safe hopping. Final spell crystal has a star icon; a large interaction prompt appears after third wave.

RUBY: “My biggest wiggle is coming!”

EXPLORER: “And my brushstroke is ready!”

Mechanic: Player jumps or stands on a clearly marked berry ledge to avoid wave one; repeats with wave two; dashes to final marked safe spot as wave three passes. No exact-frame execution. The Wonderbrush stroke becomes available after the third wave, while ambient motion continues. Default settings use generous timing; reduced-motion version keeps visible stationary rings and calm pulse bars.

Final response: Crystal splits into weightless paper petals. Ruby uncurls, wings expand slowly, eye highlights brighten; no pain/shock expression. Zero graphic impact. Three crystal icons turn into three open-flower icons.

Checkpoint: `ruby_phase_3` and immediately `ruby_restoration_pending` BEFORE starting the cosmetic transition; scene must recover if the player closes the browser mid-cinematic.

R08 — THE RED THAT CAME HOME | Signature restoration cinematic

Cinematic duration target: 12–18 seconds with `Skip` and reduced-motion 3–5-second fallback; timing provisional.

C01: Tight on a warm red paint bead forming in the freed crystal. **C02:** It rolls onto Ruby's rounded snout; her eyes widen and she laughs. **C03:** Paint energy flows through gray berry stems in branching paths; physically existing mesh materials interpolate from desaturated to red. **C04:** Red spreads across berries, red-painted roof trim, ribboned arches and one cloth sash on the Explorer; blue, yellow, green, purple and orange world materials REMAIN LOCKED. **C05:** Orbit around Ruby as her restored red body, rosy cheeks and textured wing membranes are revealed. **C06:** Wide vista to the orchard and distant village: newly red objects stand out against a beautifully neutral environment. **C07:** Frame on child and Pip with ruby-red sash.

Music: Original gentle orchestral swell + celesta + soft hand percussion; no licensed music. **SFX:** leaf tinkles, brush-whoosh, happy dragon hiccup. Avoid intense white-screen bloom, strobe or screen shake.

RUBY: “My wings feel light again! Take this Ember Dye. It can help you make a friend.”

EXPLORER: “You did it, Ruby!”

RUBY: “We did it. Even with all those wobbly berries.”

PIP: “Look! Red is back. And so is Ruby's big, brave smile.”

On-screen text + icon: `RED RESTORED` • berry icon • `RUBY EMBER DYE` (permanent recipe key, never spent) • `FLAME BURST` (Lord power, not a paid feature).

Persistence and art restriction: Ruby restoration drives a material-tag registry. Only approved red-channel materials change, rather than tinting the entire scene red with a fullscreen filter. Save `restored.red=true` before/with scene transition; idempotent reward grant. When loading after completion, every correct object remains red and Ruby remains restored.

R09 — FLAME COURTYARD | Reward teaching sequence

Why Flame Burst: Expanded Bible makes the ordinary dash a beginning traversal move and Ruby's new power an elemental brush stroke. Flame Burst is a joyful magical *painting* beam, not a damaging weapon. It activates marked red targets and melts wax seals only.

PIP: “Your dash got you there. Your new flame paints the target!”

Tutorial 1, EASY: Three wax seals on a broad low wall. Cast `F` / accessibility action at the matching torch/berry glyph and see wax gently melt like crayon. Safe, untimed.

Tutorial 2, COMBINED: One rolling berry passes through a lane; basic dash to the safe platform and cast Flame Burst at a torch-shaped switch. Clearly marked landing pad; failure respawns immediately, any already-lit seal persists.

Tutorial 3, LATER MASTERY (roadmap): Optional path requires timing between two berry lanes and activating a distant red buoy in Chapter 2. Do not gate Chapter 1 completion behind a later-region mechanic.

RUBY: “Thank you for showing me that brave doesn't mean perfect.”

EXPLORER: “It means we can try again.”

Reward UI: one clear, non-commercial inventory update. `ruby_ember_dye` is a permanent recipe unlock; its future crafting use is teased but Purple Dragon is NOT available until Bloop also supplies blue.

R10 — ONE COLOR, MANY STORIES | Outro and next chapter tease

Camera: Walk beside restored red berry groves; compare an earlier gray trail against new red fruit. Pip and Ruby meet at the orchard arch. A folded-paper wave motif stirs on a signpost toward Whisperwave Bay, but **BLUE itself remains unavailable and scenery stays unpainted**.

PIP: “One color found. Two more primary paints to discover!”

RUBY: “If you see anyone who thinks they're making a mess... remind them to keep trying.”

EXPLORER: “I will. Bye, Ruby!”

PIP: “Hear that? Something sounds like splashing... our next friend might need help.”

On-screen: `CHAPTER 1 COMPLETE` / `Red • Ruby Ember Dye • Flame Burst unlocked` / `Next: Whisperwave Bay — Coming in Chapter 2`. If Chapter 2 is NOT built, label it as a locked preview, not a working button.

Save: `chapter_1_complete`, location Hush Hollow or Ruby overlook based on safe checkpoint design. Allow replay without paying rewards twice.

F. Side quests — detailed content for full Chapter 1; beta can stage after main path is verified

SQ-R1 — LOST BERRY BASKET

NPC: Elderberry the market gardener, with enormous knitted mittens. **Objective:** Find three misplaced basket handles using shape-icon map guidance; one under a bridge, one next to jam mill, one on a safely reachable ledge. **EXPLORER:** “These don't have to be in the perfect place, do they?” **ELDERBERRY:** “The best basket is the one we bring home together.” **Completion:** 150 Color Coins, one unique scrapbook sticker, +1 Rainbow Ticket, per proposal. No timed failure.

SQ-R2 — ORCHARD BELL CHOIR

NPC: Two shy berry bells. **Objective:** Reach two friendly neighbors with basic dash/jump (and later optional Flame Burst switch), then arrange three symbol-marked bell notes. Text-symbol alternatives for hearing differences. **PIP:** “A choir can sound lovely even when every bell is a little different.” **Completion:** same proposed optional reward schedule.

SQ-R3 — JAM-JAR BRIDGE RESCUE

NPC: Reformed Jester. **Objective:** Place three illustrated bridge pieces circle -> leaf -> star while background slow berry rolls give optional manageable movement pressure. Hints never shame the child. **JESTER:** “A bridge doesn't have to be straight to help our friends cross.” **Completion:** same proposed optional reward schedule.

Beta implementation gate: Quests may be implemented after the core Ruby encounter has passed QA; never place nonfunctional quest buttons or award locked reward currencies without a visible in-game explanation. If the beta omits quests, mark the quest catalog as planned content in internal documents, not as already present.

G. Dialogue rules and performances

- Pip: enthusiastic, gently humorous, never a scolding teacher. Speaks at the moment a player needs assistance, not every three seconds. Clear 1–2-sentence voice lines and captions; no jargon.
- Explorer: curious, capable, kind; identical spoken text across boy/girl options. No stereotypes, no child-blaming on mistakes.
- Ruby: soft mezzo/alto or warm low character voice, trembling when afraid, growing lighter as crystal seals break. Expressive, never vicious.
- Jam-Jar Jester: playful bureaucratic fussiness; laugh *with* the character, not at a frightened being.
- Narrator: optional soothing introduction; voice must not be essential for understanding gameplay.
- Pauses: gameplay controls only disabled during short, actually implemented cinematics, with SKIP. Unvoiced beta must still show perfectly timed subtitles and emotion animations.

H. Gameplay systems and concrete logic

Input (desktop beta; actual platform support must be tested)

WASD/arrows move; mouse look/drag camera; SPACE jump; SHIFT basic dash (available from prologue); E Wonderbrush context interaction; F Flame Burst after Ruby; ESC pause; H contextual hint; M palette view (locked paints clearly marked). Controller and touch schemes are *planned*, not supported until tested on actual hardware. The earlier starter ZIP still uses Shift as Crimson Dash after Red: Claude MUST detect, document and refactor this mismatch carefully with save migration.

Core object tags

Use authored metadata: `paintChannel: 'red'|'blue'|'yellow'|null`; `paintableOnRestore`; `interactionGlyph`; `safeAnchor`; `isAccessibleIcon`; `chapterGate`, `rewardId`. Natural skin tones and neutral accessibility UI accents are exempt from color locking. Do not key quest progress to raw mesh UUIDs generated every run.

Suggested save schema (adapt, do not paste over working code blindly)

```
{
  schemaVersion: 2,
  chapterId: 'ruby_orchard',
  checkpointId: 'ruby_mirror_tutorial',
  explorerPreset: 'girl',
  guardians: {ruby: false, bloop: false, sol: false, verdan: false, auron: false, nox: false,
amara: false},
  primaryPaints: {red: false, blue: false, yellow: false},
  mixedPaints: {purple: false, orange: false, green: false},
  abilities: {jump: true, basicDash: true, flameBurst: false},
  permanentDyes: [],
  boss: {rubyPhase: 0, rubyMirrors: [0,0,0], rubyCompletedCrystals: [false,false,false]},
  quests: {}, rewardLedger: [], settings: {mode: 'adventure', subtitles: true, reducedMotion:
false}
}
```

`schemaVersion` above is a PROPOSAL. First inspect and migrate the real existing save key `color-me-back-demo-v1` rather than resetting saves. Write robust guards for corrupt local storage; checkpoint and reward writes must be idempotent.

Boss independent state machine

`INTRO -> PHASE_1_RUNNING -> PHASE_1_CLEAR -> PHASE_2_RUNNING -> PHASE_2_CLEAR -> PHASE_3_RUNNING -> FINAL_CRYSTAL_CLEAR -> RESTORATION -> REWARD -> COMPLETE`. Hazard scheduler in each running phase ticks INDEPENDENTLY of `puzzleInteracting`. Cancels/restarts upon loss of focus/pause; cannot hit while a cutscene has disabled input. Saved checkpoint restores puzzle and hazard state safely. Phase progress persists; accessibility options alter cadence but not rewards.

Difficulty

Story: one clear soft hazard every 9–12 seconds, larger dodge window, optional hazard pause and auto-aim. Adventure (default): every 5–7 seconds, puzzle/hazard simultaneous. Brave: every 3–5 seconds, still fair and nonviolent. A useful tell sequence: ~2-second ground marker -> ~1.5-second landing/avoid -> ~2–3 seconds safe interact -> ~1 second response. These are initial tuning goals and must be measured by playtesting.

I. Acceptance and regression tests — require evidence, not a promise

1. New game starts with ZERO restored primary pigments, regardless of hero preset.
2. Both explorers have exact same camera, move speed, jump arc, collider and unlocked ability states.
3. Prologue teaches and grants basic dash BEFORE boss; Ruby grants Flame Burst only AFTER successful rescue.
4. Wonderbrush tap interacts only with the appropriate symbol; mirror turn snaps 90 degrees and shows ghost ray.
5. Berry telegraphs have text/shape + sound cue; no offscreen surprise impact, no unwinnable mirror position.
6. Ruby phase 2 hazards continue while all THREE mirrors are being solved in Adventure, demonstrably in recorded browser test.
7. Stage clear saves; reload after phase 2 resumes at phase 3, not phase 1.
8. Three failed dodges offer slower hazard assistance, without calling the child bad or removing rewards.
9. Completing phase 3 triggers Red restoration exactly ONCE; reloading restores red tags and Ruby's kind appearance.
10. Blue, yellow and all secondary pigment channels remain UNLOCKED/gray after Ruby; natural skin tones remain inclusive.
11. Reward ledger grants Ruby Ember Dye and Flame Burst exactly once; inventory reads consistent after reload.
12. Flame Burst activates three red-marked wax targets and works after save/load; no NPC can be damaged.
13. Cutscene skip returns to a valid checkpoint, prevents stuck input and does not duplicate rewards.
14. Pause stops hazard simulation. Reduced motion removes zoom/flash but preserves the readable color change.
15. `npm install`, `npm run check`, `npm test`, `npm run build` results are reported exactly; a real browser run is required to say playable.
16. Both heroes finish the 20–30-minute beta route on actual tested hardware without crashes or softlocks.
17. Keyboard input tested now; touch/gamepad only advertised after separate device testing.
18. No paid store, chat, unconsented child image upload or external ad tracking in beta.

J. Sign-off before chapter 2

- ☐ Creator chooses whether Flame Burst/basic Dash supersedes old Crimson Dash reward.
- ☐ Creator approves the chubby/rounded, toy-like explorer direction using one boy and one girl turntable.
- ☐ Creator approves Ruby's corrupted-versus-restored model and three-phase arena diagram.
- ☐ Game actually runs with correct checkpoint and core interactions; complete recorded end-to-end desktop playtest.
- ☐ Creator approves restoration cinematic against actual 3D environment, not merely a rendered poster.
- ☐ Copy chapter 1 folder and tagged build as an immutable milestone before adding Chapter 2.

End — Chapter 1 script. Next artifact is a separate visual design specification; do not fabricate final renders or rigs before model-sheet approvals.

COLOR ME BACK! — RUBY ORCHARD

Chapter 1 art, color, weather, camera, animation and asset production specification | v1.0

Status: Original art-direction PROPOSAL derived from the Expanded Development Bible, especially sections A3, D0/D1, E3/E5, F3, K, M and N. This is a look-development brief, not generated 3D asset data. Each asset below needs creator approval, modeling, rigs where applicable, engine integration and actual rendering QA. *It Takes Two* may inspire creative ambition, elaborate environmental scale, narrative-driven mechanics and an inviting atmosphere, but do not copy its protected artwork, environments, characters or shapes.

1. ONE-SENTENCE LOOK

A charming, premium-feeling handcrafted **toy-scale 3D fantasy** that starts as a beautifully textured pearl-gray orchard and becomes a glowing tapestry of ripe ruby-red fruit when the child rescues a gentle dragon — lush and cinematic, but readable and safe for children ages five to ten.

2. The non-negotiable visual style contract

- Hero proportions **2.7–3.2 heads tall**; oversized head and expressive eyes, softly rounded chubby cheeks/limbs, broad friendly silhouette. Both explorer options have exactly matched movement hitboxes and scale.
- Rounded, bevelled shapes; cloth/felt stitches; painted-plastic, sculpted-clay, subtle paper and polished wood. Material variation is vital: the world should not look like a collection of default spheres on a flat plane.
- Rich detail by **layering silhouette, composition, textures, decals, parallax and lighting**, rather than cluttering paths or adding huge amounts of high-frequency detail.
- No realistic pores, photoreal adults, anime fashion models, glossy human anatomy, sharp threatening teeth, gore or oversaturated neon across the whole view.
- Legendary pet skins may later be highly elaborate, but every standard pet gives the same functional ability for free and seven palettes are included when a legendary skin is ever acquired.
- No green grass, brilliant blue skies or yellow sunflowers physically restored in Chapter 1; new Red is earned only at Ruby's restoration. Natural character skin tones remain natural throughout, as do small accessible UI highlights.

3. World-scale and composition language

A child explorer is about 1.0 **relative world unit** in this design model (actual engine scale should be consistent, not forced). Berry trees loom 6–9 child-heights high; berries are huge enough to act as rolling scenery, not photoreal fruit. Bridges are giant leaf mats stitched with rope. Houses are lumpy, clay-sculpted towers with round windows and thick trim; pathways arc in S- and C-shaped

lines so the composition reveals new landmarks progressively. Use foreground framing (hanging berry stalks), clear midground travel surfaces, and meaningful backgrounds (jam mill, hill ridge and Ruby's crystal grove). Silhouettes must read at gameplay distance.

Distinct visual landmarks:

1. The child's bedroom window with three paper cutouts: berry, wave, sun.
2. Hush Hollow Clockbird sign, village plaza and soft-woven berry arch.
3. The enormous bent Berrybell Tree with two fruit hanging like wind-chimes.
4. A jam mill with stacked ceramic jars and swaying paper sails.
5. Three standing mirrors on a circular tiled lily motif.
6. A distant glowing crystal ring around Ruby's cave-like but daylight-filled nest.
7. The Ruby arena: a light marble/wood circle surrounded by cushions of fruit, with a broad safe central island.
8. A high sunset-facing overlook for color-restoration camera orbit, although sky itself does not turn yellow/orange.

4. Color design — control the payoff

Function	Before Ruby	After Ruby	Example digital swatch*
Sky haze	Gray pearl	Still gray pearl in Chapter 1	#CAD0D5
Stone paths	Chalk/cool pebble	Mostly chalk/cool pebble	#ADB4B9
Bark	Weathered graphite/brown-gray	Still muted neutral	#766F70
Locked apple/berry red	Desaturated cherry-gray	Berry red	#D64F59
Restore wave accent	Warm white-pink translucency	Settles into red paint	#EF4444
Roof/red fabric embroidery	Neutral plum-gray	Warm coral/red	#C94D4A
Ruby dragon's restored scales	Stone-gray/lilac-gray	Soft warm red with coral underside	#D94A59, #F48A7A
Ruby Ember Dye item glyph	Monochrome icon with outline	Ruby red bottle + berry glyph	#EF4444
Visual accessibility highlight	Soft white plus symbol	Same soft white plus symbol	#F3EEE8

*Swatches are suggested artist/technical references, NOT color-science tests, fixed canon or final game textures. Use perceptual grayscale shader or authored before/after materials; don't alter all pixels with a uniform red filter. Colors don't have to be identical across UI / physically shaded materials. Be especially careful with blue/yellow/green elements while Red is the sole restored pigment.

Palette hierarchy: 65% soothing neutral; 25% textural cool/warm gray; 10% tiny non-diegetic UI/glow accents BEFORE Ruby. After Ruby, red should be the first strong saturated **environmental pigment**, not a full-scene red wash. Preserve lightness/value contrast for monochrome readability.

5. Weather and lighting by scene

Area	Time/weather	Lighting	Motion/environment audio
Bedroom	clouded midmorning	broad window bounce, gentle side shadow	curtain drift, ceramic crayon box taps
Hush Hollow square	brighter cloud cover	diffuse neutral key, edge rim on player	bird-shaped wind vane clicks, paper flags wave
Orchard entrance	hazy late morning	soft volumetric bands through oversized trees	leaf rustle, distant rolling berry rattle
Mirror Garden	filtered clearing	directional white reflection, crisp focal glints	quiet glass hum, soft petals
Jam Mill	mild breeze, shifting cloud shadows	stronger ambient occlusion, warm-neutral bounce	pots clack, jam bells, springy blob boings
Ruby Arena	clearing clouds, no major storm	big top fill so landing zones always readable; crystal rim	musical berry thumps, dragon breaths
Restoration	cloud breaks locally	red bounce on nearby geometry, controlled soft glow	orchestral swell, leaf chatter, sparkle arcs
Flame Courtyard	calm afternoon	crisp friendly key light, non-flashing red glyphs	wax fizz, gentle brush whoosh

Weather is atmospheric, NOT a difficulty modifier. Do not introduce hard rain, storms, blinding glare, screen-space fog, or aggressive lightning during the beta. No flicker that could cause photosensitivity issues. Use reduced-motion option to simplify drifting particles, cinematic sweeps and restoration effects.

6. The two Explorers

Shared rig/collider: identical overall height, pivot placement, foot contact, reach distance, jump arc, dash timing and camera framing. Personality-neutral story dialogue.

Boy concept: round head, expressive brows, soft nose, chubby-cheek silhouette, practical baggy hoodie or short jacket, cuffed trousers, chunky sneakers, small sash for restored Red. Hairstyle variations must not force a gender stereotype.

Girl concept: matching round head and scale; soft stylized curls or braid option; practical jacket/ overalls and chunky sneakers; mirrored sash location, identical grip on Wonderbrush. Avoid adult silhouette, makeup, long fashion heels and exaggerated eye makeup. A blank 2D earlier reference should never be accepted as a 3D model or finished turntable.

Both: natural inclusive skin tones not subject to color loss; before restoration, clothing begins desaturated. Start with 3 free outfits in the eventual full creator; beta may use 1 approved hero outfit each and not falsely present unmade customization options. Expression set: wonder / concern / courage / laughing / pride. Animation set: idle breath, walk, jog, start-stop, jump, land, dash, tap, sweep, turn mirror, bounce reaction, hug/high five, victory.

Camera and image approval: for each hero: front, side, back, 3/4 turntable with the SAME lens/ lighting/background; expression sheet; in-game scale comparison beside Pip and Ruby; gameplay-distance full-scene image; silhouette test in grayscale. No asset approved from a single glossy poster.

7. Pip — the small companion that carries the heart

Shape: 0.35 child-heights, floating soft-bristle brush with short wooden body, ring eyes, eyebrows sculpted like brush bristles, optional two tiny gloved hands, flexible paint drop tail. Colors remain restrained: natural warm wood can exist, but magical pigment locked. Hover motion small and rhythmic; avoid covering sightlines during jumps or mirrors. 5 readable expressions: intrigued, concerned, excited, pointing, relieved. Pip's suggestion halo uses an icon and subtle outline rather than a flash.

8. Ruby — the character centerpiece

Neutral/corrupted: a plump, friendly dragon like a soft bean-shaped plush; thick rounded muzzle, large eyes, cushiony paws, little horn buds, soft broad wings. Her body is mostly gray-lilac and dusted by a pale cloudy magical seal; the three spell crystals hover at a distance without piercing or injuring her. Face conveys worried perfectionism and gentle apology, not aggression.

Restored: same mesh and recognizably same face! Soft berry-red scales, salmon underside, coral wing membranes with embroidered-looking vein patterns, tiny warm glow on cheek and horns, joyful full-wing stretch. Height ~2–2.8 child heights (provisional for framing); collider is non-damage and separate from arena hazards. Animation set: frightened curl, eye glance, trembling wings, soft berry hiccup, head tilt, worried wave, relief stretch, smile, happy wave. She cannot be hit with a damaging attack; only separate crystals have interactive receivers.

Art approval requires corrupted/restored front/side/back/three-quarter, profile next to both heroes, gameplay-distance (not just close portrait), wing stretch storyboard, and VFX-off readability.

9. Jam-Jar Jester and ordinary hazards

Jester: original stubby jar silhouette, paper crown, jam-splatter bowtie, eyes inside clear jar front, rubbery rounded base, comical spring hop. Gray before Ruby. Friendly moving target, never a person to harm. Three bowls and icon markings show where bounces must land. Its “defeat” animation is a pop of harmless berry mist followed by relief.

Bouncing Berry: oversized round fruit with big stamped circle/stripe symbol, no angry face; path predictable and telegraphed. **Ink Twig:** felt-stick with worried doodled eyes and soft leaves; uncurl when a spell tag is brushed away. All characters need neutral + 3/4 + telegraph sheet.

10. Key prop and FX inventory for beta

- Bedroom: teddy, mirror, window with painted cutouts, crayon tray, Wonderbrush cradle.
- Village: 2 star seals, berry arch, 6 modular toy houses, market/cart, signage, safe jump stripe.
- Orchard: Berrybell Tree, 5 giant berry types/arrangements, 3 modular branch platforms, 2 fence patterns, 4 jam signs, ink twig, rolling berry.
- Mirror Garden: reversible 90° mirror base, preview rays, receiver, exit gate.
- Jam Mill: 3 icon pots, Jester actor, 2 landing telegraphs, jar redirect plate, checkpoint alcove.
- Ruby Arena: 3 crystals (distinct icon shape), 3 mirrors, 3 berry landing markers, 3 phase UI indicators, safe island, 3 stomp-ring variants.
- Restoration: paint wave paths registered to actual red-capable meshes, Ruby material swap/ interpolation, Explorer red sash, controlled original music sting and simple particles.

- Flame Courtyard: 3 wax seals, 1 torch switch, 1 easy berry lane, 1 reward altar.

Required effects: 1) brush tap, 2) brush sweep, 3) neutral preview beam, 4) telegraph landing ring, 5) berry bounce squish, 6) crystal petal dissolve, 7) red paint wave, 8) Ruby wing shimmer, 9) Flame Burst brush trail, 10) wax melt, 11) checkpoint confirmation, 12) softened low-VFX alternatives for all of the above.

11. 3D production practicality

Every image concept is only a guide. Production needs meshes with sensible topology, UV mapping, textured materials, rig/animations for characters, LODs or culling when appropriate, collision proxies, compressed textures, GLB/glTF export, and runtime tests. Start with approved art sheets, then inexpensive greybox, then one showcase environment pass, not thirty disconnected glamorous stills. Build modular scenery, use instancing for fruit and leaves, cap dynamic shadows/lights to tested desktop budgets. Frame rate target only after real profiling. Prioritize camera clarity, collision and responsiveness over cinematic heavy rendering.

12. Camera language and cinematography

- Gameplay camera: child-height third-person follow, softly damped, collision-aware, minimum vertical angle to keep jumps visible, avoids having huge berries cover the hero.
- Discovery: long, curved reveal of Ruby framed by branches; no repeated giant cinema cuts.
- Puzzles: slight shoulder pan to show target; ghost beam always world-space; rotatable camera while hazards remain active.
- Mini-boss: broad 3/4 framing of all three pots, not a zoom on the Jester's face.
- Boss: cinematic intro with safely paused hazards; over-the-shoulder play with crystal and landing markers both visible.
- Phase 2: <2-second overhead preview ONLY while safe, then control returns; never lock camera in overhead gameplay if it hides berry warnings.
- Restoration: controlled 12–18-second series of close->wide shots with skip and motion-reduced path. At least one in-engine uncut shot must prove real material recoloring, not pre-rendered footage.

13. UI design and accessibility

Round translucent parchment-like UI surfaces with sufficient contrast, gentle pop animation; large outlined lettering, friendly icon labels. HUD = (upper left) current task, (upper right) three crystal/ flower phase icons, (bottom right) context brush / dash / future Flame Burst, (bottom center) Pip hint line. Text must remain readable against gray/ red. Both in-game world markers and UI icons mark warning zones. An animated hazard is never communicated by red vs gray alone. Include subtitle backgrounds, font sizing, camera sensitivity, reduced motion, brightness, and Story/ Adventure/Brave choices. Keep no ads, external chat or purchasing in beta.

14. Sound and music direction

Original playful orchestral / woodwind / mallet textures: bedroom music-box mystery, village pizzicato warmth, orchard hand percussion, jam-mill comedic tuba/clarinet, Ruby arena upbeat pulse and bell telegraphs, red restoration soaring strings with childlike celesta. Sound mixing: danger cue remains intelligible but quiet/soothing; accessible caption mirrors cues; no licensed soundtrack from *It Takes Two*. Dynamic layers make the player feel like the world awakens after Red.

15. Visual concept request order — ONE at a time for approval

1. CMB_HERO_BOY_BASE_TURNTABLE_v01 (front, side, back, 3/4 + expressions).
2. CMB_HERO_GIRL_BASE_TURNTABLE_v01 (matched height, same rig + expressions).
3. CMB_COMPANION_PIP_BASE_TURNTABLE_v01.
4. CMB_PROP_WONDERBRUSH_ACTION_v01.
5. CMB_LORD_RUBY_CORRUPTED_RESTORED_v01.
6. CMB_ENV_HUSH_HOLLOW_WIDE_GRAY_v01.
7. CMB_ENV_RUBY_ORCHARD_WIDE_GRAY_v01.
8. CMB_ENV_RUBY_ORCHARD_PATH_LAYOUT_v01.
9. CMB_ENV_RUBY_ARENA_TOPDOWN_3PHASE_v01.
10. CMB_ENV_RUBY_ORCHARD_BEFORE_AFTER_v01 (same camera and geometry, only unlocked red objects restored).
11. CMB_NPC_JAM_JAR_JESTER_BASE_v01.
12. CMB_PROP_MIRROR_AND_TELEGRAPH_v01.

Each asset approval requires `[ ] neutral turntable`, `[ ] coherent 3/4 key art`, `[ ] scale beside Explorer`, `[ ] gameplay-distance preview`, `[ ] low-VFX view`, `[ ] original rights/ownership checked`, `[ ] approval note`. Never treat an illustrative PDF image as rigged 3D. Never generate huge asset batches before creator signs off on hero, Ruby and one environment style.

16. Visual QA and rejection criteria

Reject art if it looks like generic block/sphere primitives without intentional detail, over-blown bloom, adult character proportions, copied *It Takes Two* environment, inaccessible color-only threat telegraphs, gray world that is muddy rather than beautiful, post-restoration blue/yellow leakage, Ruby depicted as scary/violent, wildly inconsistent hero proportions, or concept images masquerading as complete game models. Approve when the scene reads clearly at real gameplay distance, shows multiple material types, consistent light direction, original craftsmanship and spectacular but controlled red restoration.

Sources: Expanded Game Development Bible pp.4–5, 7–8, 15–18, 27–28, 32–35, 38–39, 40–41. External comparative inspiration: official EA *It Takes Two* gameplay article (2021) and Hazelight ArtStation environment-art discussion (2021). All concrete designs here are proposed original *Color Me Back!* creations.

SOURCE CHANGES / CREATOR APPROVAL REGISTER

ID	Issue	Source distinction	Recommended beta working assumption	Creator approval
A-01	Ruby ability	Earlier Chapter 1: Crimson Dash after Ruby; Expanded Bible pp.4, 7–8, 16: free basic dash + Flame Burst	Follow expanded design; migration required	PENDING
A-02	Story scope	Original 3 primary-color Guardians; Expanded Bible proposes seven Color Lords	Chapter 1 implements only Ruby; save schema reserves later seven	PENDING
A-03	Ruby chapter length	Original 18–25m; expansion 55–80m plus optional	Beta core 20–30m, expand without retcon	PENDING
A-04	Visual approval	Earlier illustrated character cards vs updated toy-like 2.7–3.2-head 3D models	Updated style spec for future 3D modeling	PENDING
A-05	Boss pressure	Older gentle 3 phases; new persistent pressure during mirror interaction	Active independent hazards in Adventure; Story assist option	PENDING
A-06	Pet/cosmetic economy	Eight species and seven cosmetic palettes proposed; 600 Gems and 660 F2P path proposed	NO shop or pet abilities built into Chapter 1 beta; future contracts reserved	PENDING
A-07	Platform	Browser desktop first; phone/gamepad only after tests	Desktop web initially; do not advertise other support	PENDING
A-08	Art production	Reference PDFs show moods and 2D assets, not final meshes	Approve hero, Ruby, environment model sheets before costly full art	PENDING
A-09	Source video	No game video uploaded in current turn	Document from PDF and source ZIP only	WAITING FOR VIDEO

Ten golden rules checklist (must appear in engineering reviews)

- ☐ All functional story powers are free, no P2W
- ☐ Seven cosmetic palettes come with each exclusive pet skin
- ☐ At least one 600 Gem exclusive reachable through achievable free progression, once store is implemented
- ☐ Young-looking, cute, soft-edged, rounded 3D characters
- ☐ Legendary skins remain functionally identical to standard pets
- ☐ Threats continue during puzzles in Adventure mode; assist available
- ☐ Explicit safe tutorial -> easy test -> combo -> later reuse for powers

- ☐ Lords rescued nonviolently, the Fade helped
- ☐ Solo story first, Season Two co-op only if approved
- ☐ Creator approval precedes locking new proposals

Reference locations

- Expanded Bible pp.4–5: 10 golden rules, style contract
- pp.7–8: prologue and Ruby story
- pp.15–18: brush, ability registry, active hazards and mirror implementation
- pp.21–24: proposed currency, pricing and child safeguards (NOT built now)
- pp.27–35: asset counts, workflow, visual prompts and code architecture
- pp.37–39: acceptance tests, developer handoff and unresolved choices
- pp.40–41: Ruby boss phase dialogue appendix
- Original `Color_Me_Back_Chapter_1.pdf`: Crimson Dash and short original chapter
- Earlier `Color_Me_Back_GAME_CODE.zip`: JS ES modules, existing placeholder guardians and old ability progression

CHAPTER 01 / RUBY ORCHARD

Color locks, before-and-after palette, icon rules

BEFORE: MUTED AND BEAUTIFUL

Pearl sky / locked	Cool pearl neutral	#CAD0D5
Paving stone / neutral	Readable light/dark texture	#ADB4B9
Trunk / neutral	Muted organic structure	#766F70
Berry locked / gray	Gray before Ruby rescue	#8A858C
Ruby locked / gray lilac	Not bright red until rescue	#8F8893
White symbol / accessible	Shape cues remain visible	#F3EEE8

AFTER: RED RETURNS TO TAGGED OBJECTS ONLY

Ripe berry red		#D64F59
Red restoration accent		#EF4444
Painted roof accent		#C94D4A
Ruby scale red		#D94A59
Ruby coral underside		#F48A7A

NO early blue, yellow, green, orange or purple environment restoration.

Natural skin tones and white UI glyphs are not locked by the grayscale treatment.

Proposed concept swatches, not approved textures or measured accessibility contrast.

COLOR LANGUAGE / GAMEPLAY RULES

Chapter 1 beta symbolic cues and future-proofing

BERRY / CIRCLE

Ruby berry hazard landing area

Shape + text + bell. 2-second visible telegraph.

TRIANGLE / CRYSTAL

First spell seal

Interact with E / Wonderbrush only.

ARROW / MIRROR

Direction / 90 degree turn

Neutral white preview ray; no aim precision.

STAR / CRYSTAL

Final Ruby seal

Paint only AFTER stomp waves end.

FLAME / TORCH

Flame Burst power receiver

Unlocked only after Ruby is rescued.

FLOWER / CHECK

Phase saved successfully

Each of three phases grants a persistent checkpoint.

LOCK / WAVES

Blue and other paints unavailable

No automatic purple/green/orange mixing before recipes.

DYE / VIAL

Permanent Ruby Ember Dye

Free recipe KEY, never paid or consumed.